

*Experience and sound reasoning
over products and brands...*

Darkstack7

**Cybersecurity Services Deck
8/27/25**



Darkstack7

Cyber Security Services

Fractional CISO

Provides experienced, on-demand security leadership to develop and drive a tailored cybersecurity strategy.

Security Consulting / Advisory

Delivers expert guidance to assess risks, strengthen defenses, and align cybersecurity initiatives with your organization

GRC Assessments

Establish & maintain effective Governance, Risk, and Compliance using frameworks to manage risk, meet regulatory requirements

Penetration Testing

Testing service identifies and exploits vulnerabilities to strengthen your systems before attackers can.

Incident Response Assist

Expert incident response support to quickly contain, investigate, and remediate cyber threats when they occur.

Sensitive Insider Investigations

Service uncovers, analyzes, and mitigates internal threats to protect your organization's critical assets and reputation.

Cyber Tabletop Exercises

Exercise simulates real-world cyber incidents to test, train, and enhance your team's response readiness.

Managed Security Services

Delivers continuous, expert-driven security operations 24/7 through trusted partnerships

Core Capabilities

Public Speaking & Training



DARKSTACK7

Joshua R. Nicholson

Managing Partner / CISO

Background

- ✓ Over 24 Years of Leadership Experience: Proven record in managing dynamic teams and driving success in multiple industries.
- ✓ Experience coupled with direct CXO and Board transformation enablement skills.
- ✓ Incident Response (IR): leading Incident Response Commander activities.
- ✓ Strong business acumen, extensive industry relationships, expert technical skills in several domains of IT and Security.
- ✓ Proven history delivering on large scale global enterprise information security projects and programs.
- ✓ .Broad experience working and operating internationally (U.K., EU, Middle East, Asia, Australia)
- ✓ Multiple Industry certs: CISSP, CISM, SANS-CGIH, SANS-GCWN SANS-GWEB, CCNP,

Core Expertise

- ✓ Digital Forensics & Incident Response
- ✓ Network Security Engineer
- ✓ CISO & Executive Risk Advisory
- ✓ Security Operations Center (SOC)
- ✓ Executive Leadership (Board Support)
- ✓ Host of "Cyber Security America" podcast (YouTube, Apple, Spotify)

Leadership Positions

- Surefire Cyber
- Deepseas
- Booz Allen Hamilton
- Cofense
- Wells Frago
- Ernst & Young (EY)
- Whitney National Bank
- Northrop Grumman
- U.S. Marine Corps

Directed global incident response teams, managing hundreds of critical breaches for Fortune 500 & SMB...



Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) Virtual / Fractional

Today's CISOs are overwhelmed—facing growing threats with limited time, staff, and budget. A fractional strategic advisor or vCISO meets you where your need is—delivering executive-level leadership, without the full-time overhead.

vCISO Aspects

Strategic Leadership

Aligns security initiatives with business goals while developing long-term security strategies & roadmaps



Operational Oversight

Oversees day-to-day ops (e.g. SOC, IR, Vuln Mgt) and respond to incident while managing crisis comms



Governance, Risk, & Compliance (GRC)

Ensures compliance with legal, regulatory, and industry standards (e.g. GDPR, HIPAA, NIST) while leading risk assessments & audits



Security Architecture & Technology Enablement

Guides secure design of IT systems, cloud infrastructure, Selects and oversees the deployment of security tools and platforms



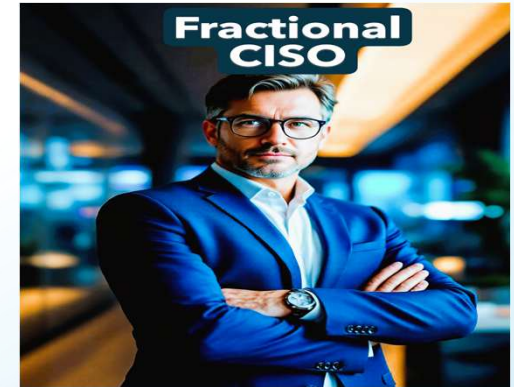
Executive Summary

What is a Virtual or Fractional CISO?

- A Virtual Chief Information Security Officer (vCISO) provides the strategic cybersecurity leadership of a program
- Fractional CISO through a flexible, cost-effective service model. Our vCISO experts work as an extension of your team
- They deliver executive-level security guidance, program management, and strategic planning to keep you covered

Strategic Importance:

vCISO services are evolving beyond traditional cybersecurity, with a growing emphasis on strategic advisory roles in areas like [AI readiness](#), [attack surface management](#), and [incident response planning](#).



Addressing Complex Threats:

vCISOs are crucial in helping organizations navigate increasingly complex cyber threats, comply with regulations, and align security strategies with business objectives.

Focus on Business Enablement:

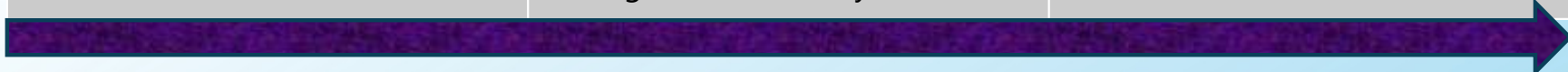
CISOs are increasingly focused on driving business growth and enabling secure business operations, with some surveys showing a shift in priorities towards innovation and strategic alignment.

Why Choose Our Virtual CISO Services?

Our services are built on proven expertise in delivering critical security operations—Incident Response, Digital Forensics, SOC management, Threat Hunting, Insider Threat programs, Threat Assessments, and Penetration Testing. Our CISOs bring deep technical backgrounds combined with business and regulatory expertise, ensuring every client is matched with the right leader to drive transformation.

The wrong fit can have serious consequences

Execution Skill Type		
Business Mgt / IT Auditor	IT Manager	Cybersecurity
Traits:		
- Lacks technical skills - Excels at policy development - Risk adverse with new tech they don't understand - Focused on executing the years Audit plan - They only see the program side of cybersecurity	- Has some technical background - Former IT only background - Can advise to some degree on new tech - Lacks tech skills to meaningfully contribute - Focuses on compliance & regulations security	- Extensive technical skills and track record - Is not so tool focused - Understands complex attack scenarios - Can lead the company directly in a Cyber Attack - Would serve as Incident Commander



Darkstack7 – Fractional CISO Service

Value Overview

Our Virtual CISO Services provides enterprise-level cybersecurity leadership without the fulltime executive cost. Our seasoned cybersecurity professionals deliver strategic guidance, risk management, and security program development tailored to your organization's unique needs.

Service Overview

- ✓ Our seasoned cybersecurity professionals deliver strategic guidance, risk management, and security program development
- ✓ We bridge the gap between regulations & controls with cybersecurity tools and solutions
- ✓ Service is built to be a program that drives down risk over time systematically
- ✓ Less engaged services fit in the category of strategic advisor for less hours

Service Model

Dedicated vCISO Assignment: Single point of contact and accountability

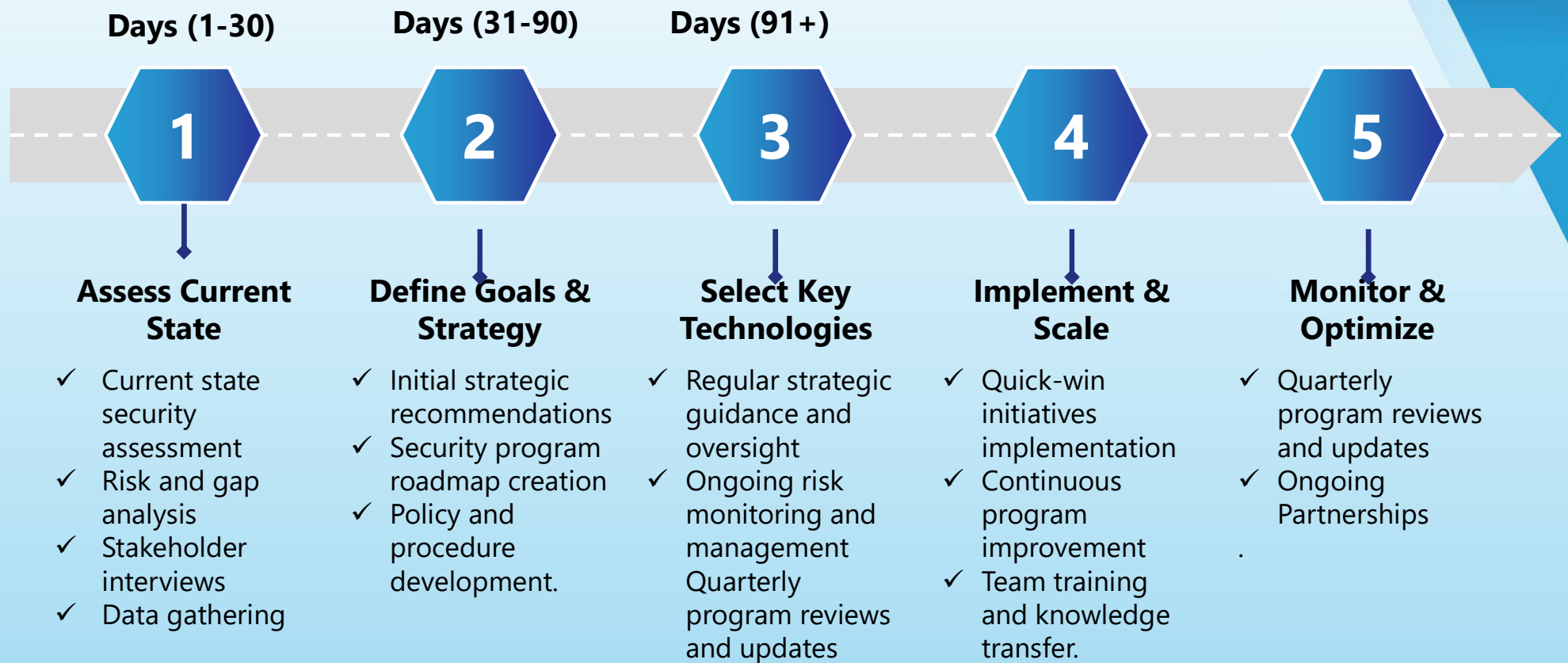
Flexible Engagement: [8/16/24] hours per month commitment

Remote and On-Site: Hybrid delivery model with quarterly on-site visits

24/7 Emergency Response: Critical incident escalation support

Executive Reporting: Monthly board-ready security reports and presentations

Cyber Risk Transformation – vCISO Roadmap



CISO Advisory Packages & Pricing

Package	Scope	Description	Monthly Reoccurring
Strategic Advisor	- 1x Monthly Office Hours - Rapid capabilities assessment - Cyber Domain Assessment - Monthly risk report if using our platform	Darkstack7's Strategic Advisor to the CISO service provides executive-level guidance to help CISOs strengthen their security programs, align with business objectives, and address emerging threats Approximately 6 – 8 hrs./monthly	\$3,000
CISO Advisor	- 2x Monthly Advisory Hours - 1x Monthly Executive Standup Call - 1x Monthly Working Session - Rapid capabilities assessment - Monthly risk report if using our platform - Quarterly Business Reviews - Annual Board presentation support	Darkstack7's CISO Advisor service delivers in-depth partnership for security leaders ready to advance their programs. We assess your current state, define a clear future vision, and create actionable roadmaps to close gaps and accelerate maturity (Approximately 20 - 24hrs./monthly)	\$8,000
Virtual CISO / Deputy CISO	- Advisory Hours - Weekly Executive Standup Call - 1x Monthly Working Session - Rapid capabilities assessment - Monthly risk report if using our platform - Quarterly Business Reviews - Annual Board presentation support - SME Support	Full-scale security leadership as part of your executive team. We provide strategic direction, oversee operations, lead program execution, support board reporting, and drive long-term transformation to ensure your organization operates at world-class security standards. (Approximately 40 hrs./weekly)	\$15,000

*Additional program hours billed out at \$250/300

1

Virtual CISO, Strategic Advisor (technical)

Provides experienced, on-demand security leadership to develop and drive a tailored cybersecurity strategy.

2

Security Consulting & Advisory

Delivers expert guidance to assess risks, strengthen defenses, and align cybersecurity initiatives with your organization

3

Governance, Risk, & Compliance (GRC)

Establish & maintain effective Governance, Risk, and Compliance using frameworks to manage risk, meet regulatory requirements

4

Incident Response Assistance

Expert-led support during cybersecurity events, ensuring your organization responds with speed and precision. we lead triage, direct containment efforts, and coordinate investigations

5

Tabletop Exercises / Cyber Wargaming

Proactive preparedness scenarios and gap analysis to enhance and validate your organization's IR capabilities, required by insurance & regs

6

Insider Threat Investigations

Forensic and behavioral investigations, containment, remediation, and legal/HR support for malicious insider and rogue IT scenarios.

7

Penetration Testing

Comprehensive vulnerability assessment and ethical hacking to identify security gaps before attackers do.



Services One Pager

**"Defending Your Business Against Digital Threats
With Elite Cybersecurity Leadership."**

*"When Cyber Threats Escalate, We Respond with
Experience, Precision, and Speed."*

Delivery Partners



Cyber Security America Podcast

Managed Services

- 24/7 MDR for endpoint
- SIEM
- cybersecurity education across audiences.

Training & Speaking

- Leadership workshops
- conference keynotes
- cybersecurity education across audiences.

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